

On the downside, Twitux only supports one Twitter account at a time. So, if you use multiple accounts and want a single client to manage them all, Twitux won't fit the bill. Besides, it doesn't have support features like viewing a user's profile, retweeting, replying to messages and URL shortening.

gTwitter

gTwitter is yet another GTK+ based client which is still under development and supports only Twitter. Its GUI is inspired by the Mac client *twittrific* (see <http://iconfactory.com/software/twittrific/>). It runs like a GNOME applet where once the application is closed, it minimises to the desktop panel.

You can configure your Twitter account by right clicking the desktop panel icon and selecting the *Preferences* option. There are two views—a tweet view and a list view. Figure 3 shows the list view.

gTwitter allows you to watch the timelines of both your friends and the public. It caches the user profile pictures locally and displays it alongside a friend's tweets. You can configure the refresh interval between 1 and 30 minutes. Manual refresh is also possible. There is still a long way to go for gTwitter and only those who want a simple GUI to post on Twitter should try this.

Qwit

Guess all you KDE folks are getting worried? Well, fear not, because there's a Qt4-based client called Qwit too. It supports Twitter, identi.ca and some other custom microblogging services like Laconica. Its user interface is simple and self-explanatory. The UI has tabs located on the left side of the app window vertically, in order to watch public/friends' timelines. The search functionality is included

there. In fact, you can customise the UI according to your needs. If you are behind a proxy, then Qwit gives the required interface in order to configure your proxy settings too.

It supports multiple account configurations. URL shortening is also integrated and you can choose from either *tr.im* or *murl.kz*. Qwit is specific on how connections are made to the online services—that is, *http://* or *https://*. This is something I haven't even found in Gwibber.

One big disadvantage here is that you do not have control



Figure 3: gTwitter only supports Twitter



Figure 4: Qwit's innovative interface

over the time interval to refresh the timelines. You can either configure it to auto-refresh or not to refresh. Thankfully, there's a sync icon which you can use in case you are not satisfied with the time interval for automatic refresh.

Choqok

This one is the icing on the cake for KDE users. It currently supports Twitter, identi.ca and custom Laconica-based services.

Unlike Qwit, Choqok is tightly integrated with KDE. It uses KWallet for storing user credentials and new tweet notifications are made using the Knotify (although, it has support for libnotify also).

Choqok has almost all the features you'll expect, with a very pleasing and easy-to-use UI. You can configure multiple accounts, and when you do, each account occupies a separate tab horizontally on top. There's a very cool feature in the list box that lists all your followers whom you can DM.

Just like the Web interface, when we mouse over any tweet, small icons appear for deleting, adding to favourites or retweeting messages! Choqok supports URL shortening via services like *is.gd*, *2tu.us* and *digg.com*. Of course, there's an option to search public timelines.

Besides, it's even integrated with *twitpic.com*, which is Twitter's cousin for posting picture updates quickly. Another interesting feature is its integration with Amarok—hit *Ctrl+L* and tweet what you're currently listening to instantly, without keying in any character. Overall, it is fairly feature-rich, and a mature enough client for all KDE users.

BTI

All you command-line addicts must be wondering what's out there for you. Well, there's BTI, which is written in C, and supports identi.ca and Twitter. Unlike the two we discussed earlier, this one isn't a full-fledged application. What it does is "allow you to pipe your bash input to Twitter or identi.ca in an easy and fast manner to annoy the whole world."

A sample run in the command line follows:

```
styles@vanji:~$ bti --version
bti - version 0.23

styles@vanji:~$ bti --host twitter
Enter twitter account: testsem
Enter twitter password: mypassword
Tweet: This is a test tweet from bti client.

styles@vanji:~$ bti --host twitter
Enter twitter account: testsem
```



Figure 5: Choqok is #1 for KDE4 users